

Fizzy drinks

- **What?** Coca-Cola
- **Who?** John Pemberton
- **Where and when?** US, 1886

One of the world's top drinks began as an herbal medicine created by the American pharmacist John Pemberton. Among its ingredients, which were made into a syrup and mixed with carbonated water, were alcohol and the then-legal drug cocaine, both later removed. More than 1.8 billion Coke products are sold daily.



Breakfast cereal

- **What?** Cornflakes
- **Who?** Dr. John Harvey Kellogg
- **Where and when?** US, 1894

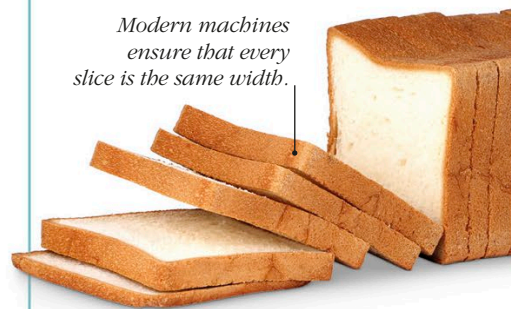
The American doctor John Kellogg ran a health spa where patients were served very plain food, which the doctor thought especially healthy. For breakfast, he gave them a simple cereal he had created using flakes of cooked corn (maize). The flakes proved so popular with the patients that Kellogg's brother, Will Keith, decided to mass produce them, and they were soon being sold around the world.

Simpler sandwiches

- **What?** Sliced bread
- **Who?** Otto Rohwedder
- **Where and when?** US, 1928

It took a while for the American engineer Otto Rohwedder to perfect his bread-slicing machine. His biggest problem was the speed at which sliced bread goes stale. He solved this by inventing a machine that not only sliced bread, but also wrapped it, keeping it fresh. Soon, nearly all the bread sold in the US was presliced.

Modern machines ensure that every slice is the same width.



Blowing bubbles

- **What?** Bubble gum
- **Who?** Walter Diemer
- **Where and when?** US, 1928

While working for a chewing gum company in Philadelphia, accountant Walter Diemer discovered an extra-stretchy gum that could easily be blown into large bubbles. Called "Dubble Bubble," the new gum was soon being sold across the country. But because Diemer had not patented his invention, rival companies soon copied it.



Modern box of Dubble Bubble gum

The first bubble gum was pink because that was the only color dye available in the factory at the time.

Noodles to go

- **What?** Instant noodles
- **Who?** Momofuku Ando
- **Where and when?** Japan, 1958

The invention of dried noodles, which can be stored for a long time, led to the creation in the 1970s of new snacks called cup or pot noodles. These are plastic pots containing a mixture of dried noodles and flavorings, which become instant meals when boiling water is added.



FAST FACTS

- The American chef Ruth Graves Wakefield invented the recipe for the chocolate chip cookie in 1938, which she sold to the food company Nestlé for just \$1—and a lifetime's supply of chocolate.
- Chewing gum was invented in 1869 by the American scientist Thomas Adams using chicle, a type of rubbery tree sap from Mexico.